

Meridian Freight OS

Exception management for mid-market freight brokers

Seed round - March 2026

hello@meridianfreight.example

The problem

- Mid-market brokers run 60-80% of shipment exceptions through email and phone
- A single mishandled exception costs an average of \$410 in penalties and re-work
- Brokers we surveyed lose 11 hours per dispatcher per week to exception chasing
- Source: internal survey of 42 brokerages, Q4 2025

Why now

- FMCSA broker transparency rules took effect January 2026
- Shippers now demand exception audit trails as a contract term
- Legacy TMS vendors price integrations at \$60K+ per year, out of reach mid-market

Product

- Meridian ingests EDI 214 and email status updates and classifies exceptions automatically
- Dispatcher console proposes a resolution and drafts the customer update
- Deploys in 3 weeks alongside the incumbent TMS - no rip and replace
- Live integrations: McLeod, Turvo, Aljex

Traction

- \$2.4M ARR as of Q2 2026
- 118% year-over-year ARR growth
- 37 paying brokerages
- Gross margin 71%
- Net revenue retention 114%
- Average contract value \$64,800
- Logo churn 6% over the trailing twelve months

Customer evidence

- Ridgeline Logistics cut exception handling time 42% in the first 90 days
- Two of the top five customers expanded seats within 6 months
- Sales cycle averages 74 days from first call to signature
- 3 of 37 customers are on annual contracts; the rest are monthly

Market

- 17,000 licensed freight brokerages in the United States
- We target the 4,100 brokerages doing \$10M-\$250M in annual freight volume
- At our current \$64,800 ACV that is a \$266M serviceable market
- Source: FMCSA licensing data and company analysis

Business model

- Annual SaaS subscription priced per dispatcher seat
- Land at 8-12 seats, expand to 30+ as brokerages consolidate desks
- CAC \$19,400 blended; payback in 14 months at current gross margin

Competition

- Incumbent TMS vendors (McLeod, Turvo) bundle basic status tracking
- Point solutions focus on tracking visibility, not exception resolution
- Our exception classification model is trained on 2.1M labelled shipment events

Team

- Dana Whitfield, CEO - 9 years at C.H. Robinson, ran a 60-person brokerage desk
- Amir Kohli, CTO - built dispatch systems at Convoy, 11 years in logistics software
- 14 full-time employees; 4 in engineering, 3 in customer success
- No full-time VP of Sales; the CEO closes all enterprise deals today

The ask

- Raising \$6M Seed
- \$12M pre-money valuation cap
- Use of proceeds: 55% engineering, 30% go-to-market, 15% general and administrative
- 24 months of runway to \$10M ARR

Milestones

- Q4 2026: 75 customers and \$5M ARR
- Q2 2027: self-serve onboarding live, CAC below \$12,000
- Q4 2027: \$10M ARR and first two enterprise shipper contracts